

Speaker 1 [00:00:03] So what would you like your partner to be called girlfriend, spouse, partner? Is there a particular word.

Speaker 2 [00:00:10] I call my wife.

Speaker 1 [00:00:13] Wife. Very good.

Speaker 2 [00:00:14] We're married now.

Speaker 1 [00:00:16] How long have you been with your wife?

Speaker 2 [00:00:19] About [1-5] and a half, almost [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:00:26] Listen, first of all, I'd like you to talk about the love affair you're currently having with your wife.

Speaker 2 [00:00:35] We met at [location]. The first time I saw her, it was love at first sight. And then, since we work together, we teased each other a bit, she looked for me a lot, I must admit, and then one day, I asked her out for a coffee. It was all part of a game, more specifically, she started a game: if I couldn't find something and she found it before me, what would I pay her? All of it? Then, after a while, after a while, I'd say, well, I'll buy you a coffee, I'll invite you for a coffee, all that... And then it ended up that at the end of the shift, I stopped and said: "Can I take your number to pay for the coffee next time? And then, well, that's how the story began.

Speaker 1 [00:01:23] So if I understand correctly, it all started as a game, so you got to know each other at work, there was a sort of challenge, a game.

Speaker 2 [00:01:30] Yes, you could say that, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:01:32] So you had a coffee and?

Speaker 2 [00:01:35] It was at that moment, on the evening of the coffee that we kissed, and since [Month] [Day], we've been together ever since.

Speaker 1 [00:01:46] Could you perhaps tell me a little more about the evolution? The development of the relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:01:55] Well, quite simply, in the beginning, she was already living with someone, but they weren't together and they were still living together in relation to their child. And then, as time went by, she started coming home a bit more often and covid came into our lives, so we were confined to my house, because at the time it was my house. We were confined to my house in [Month] and since [Month], in fact, she's never left. So, little by little, she settled in. She brought her stuff back. And now it's home, it's our cosy little nest.

Speaker 1 [00:02:31] It's our home! So you're married? If I've understood correctly.

Speaker 2 [00:02:36] Yes, we got married, but before that we had a civil partnership.

Speaker 1 [00:02:40] You're civil partners.

Speaker 2 [00:02:42] Yes, before that we were in a civil partnership and then, as we want children, we'd really like to have children, we thought marriage would be a good idea, but it's also a marriage of love, not just for children and all that, and so, right after that, in fact, not even [1-5] year after the civil partnership, we got married.

Speaker 1 [00:03:05] Right.

Speaker 2 [00:03:07] It's been [1-5] months, [Month], [Month], [Month], [Month]. We've been married for [1-4] months now.

Speaker 1 [00:03:14] You've been married for [1-5] months. You said it was a love marriage.

Speaker 2 [00:03:19] Ah bah yes. Ah yes, yes, yes, well I've never fallen in love. So this is the first time with her.

Speaker 1 [00:03:27] You've never fallen in love?

Speaker 2 [00:03:28] Never.

Speaker 1 [00:03:30] Is this the first time?

Speaker 2 [00:03:32] Yes, it's the first time I've loved someone.

Speaker 1 [00:03:35] Is this the first time you've loved someone?

Speaker 2 [00:03:37] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:03:40] Can you tell me more about that? About the relationship you have?

Speaker 2 [00:03:46] Let's just say that compared to before, because I've been a lesbian since I was very little in fact, I knew very very quickly. So yes, I've had a lot of stories, with other people, but I was just attached to them. I didn't need to be with the person. I was with her, that was fine. But with my wife, well, it's totally different. If she's not in..., if I don't see her, I don't feel good. I feel like a part of me is actually missing. And I need her all the time, she's my pillar. She's my compass, I really need her. My heart in the morning, I get up, I fall every day, I've fallen in love with her, actually.

Speaker 1 [00:04:36] You said it's your pillar, it's your compass?

Speaker 2 [00:04:38] Yes, without her, I'd never get anywhere.

Speaker 1 [00:04:43] Ah, you can't move forward without it.

Speaker 2 [00:04:45] Oh yeah no, before I was very stagnant in my life and since she came into my life, there are a lot of things in my personal life that have evolved enormously. So, yeah, she's really my mainstay.

Speaker 1 [00:05:02] So you said there are a lot of things in your personal life that have evolved?

Speaker 2 [00:05:07] Well, yeah. Well, in fact, I have a rather complicated past, that is to say I had fallen into drugs and alcohol and thanks to her, well now I don't need all that anymore, I'm completely clean from that and thanks to her, since she's been in my life, I've had the desire to get my driver's license which I've obtained. I want to have more, in fact, rather than being a tenant, well now I want to be, to have my own house with her. I want to have children. I want to continue my life for the better and with her. Keep evolving.

Speaker 1 [00:05:59] Continuing to evolve, do you feel you're evolving and perhaps projecting more?

Speaker 2 [00:06:06] Yes, I do. Something I didn't have before, in fact.

Speaker 1 [00:06:13] You told me a little bit about the relationship, how it went, how it was created. I'd like you to tell me if you had to compare the quality of your current relationship with that of your friends, for example, what would you say?

Speaker 2 [00:06:32] That is, if I had to compare my relationship with that of my friends?

Speaker 1 [00:06:40] If you had to compare the quality of your relationship with your friends?

Speaker 2 [00:06:46] I don't think it's the same. Personally, I'm not the type to worry about what's going on, but I would say that we're both friends and lovers, and when one of us isn't doing well, the other is there to support her, and vice versa. As a result, it gives us a quality that I appreciate, which is that we're really supportive, and before being in love, we're friends. That's the most important thing, something people forget. Because for them, being in a couple is love. But there's also the friendly side, the friendly attachment. We feel like best friends, but with love as well. And that's great. We can laugh about anything and everything. We'll get angry, but it won't be a long lasting quarrel. I'm a grouch, she is too, but I'll stall and so will she. So when, for example, I raise my voice, she'll start to lower it so that I'll calm down, and vice versa in fact. And I think it's true that our quality, the cutting quality, is that in fact, it's the friendship and love we have at the same time.

Speaker 1 [00:08:20] What do you find lacking in your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:08:23] Yes, I do.

Speaker 1 [00:08:27] If you were to compare the quality of your current relationship with that of your previous relationships...

Speaker 2 [00:08:35] That's got nothing to do with it. With the others, I didn't feel listened to at all, and personally, I didn't listen to them either. For me, it was we're together, ok, but they don't count on me, whereas she knows very well that she can count on me at any time. Compared to the others, it's not even comparable. My wife is here. My old relationships are non-existent, it's as if they never happened.

Speaker 1 [00:09:13] So why are they so incomparable?

Speaker 2 [00:09:17] Because I simply wasn't in love. And that changes everything too. For me, it's love, because I'm a very, very solitary person, basically. As a result, I used to prefer to spend my time with my friends than with my girlfriend. Now, it's totally the opposite. If I prefer to spend time with my wife and if I have to see my friends, I'd rather my wife be with me than be alone. But we also give each other our moments when I can do what I want on my own and so can she. But it's true that I prefer her to be with me. And enjoy my friends with her.

Speaker 1 [00:10:06] You spoke just before about the importance of being both friends for you, friends and lovers. Is this also something you didn't have in your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:10:19] No, not at all. At all, at all. I mean, it was more of a friendly, friendly attachment rather than a loving attachment, actually.

Speaker 1 [00:10:33] How can you know when you're in a relationship where there's both this friendly, friendship side and this love side? How can you?

Speaker 2 [00:10:43] Let's put it this way, my wife and I are always in the game. Like her nickname, I call her female, she'll call me female and we'll laugh about it. And I don't really know how to explain it, it's kind of strange, but I know she's like my best friend because I can confide in her. More than I confide in my current best friend and at the same time, she's my wife and I give her everything I can, in fact, all my love is for her. And I know that in any case, even if tomorrow I'm not well or she's not

well, the love side will take over from the friendship. But on the other hand, there's a friendly attachment in the sense that we'll have a laugh, because she knows that I'm someone who's always laughing out loud. I need to laugh to feel better. And that's what I like about her. Because she can switch from the friendly side to the loving side, "I'll take care of you, but don't worry, we're", and in fact I've always looked for that in a relationship, that best friend but lover side. It's fun.

Speaker 1 [00:11:56] Yeah, it's fun.

Speaker 2 [00:11:58] Yeah, I need that.

Speaker 1 [00:11:59] You need this.

Speaker 2 [00:12:01] I need this.

Speaker 1 [00:12:02] This is important. If I understand correctly, what you're describing is in fact a form of complicity that's quite natural, organic.

Speaker 2 [00:12:09] That's right. It's a certain feeling in fact, I can really be myself with her. I don't need to hide behind any false pretenses. I'm myself, I'm 100% open, I mean, everything she gets from me, it's 100% me in fact, I'm not going to, compared to my other relationships I'm not going to where I hid a bit or I didn't show my weaknesses, well she I'm going to show her because in any case, I don't have to hide. Like, I'm not someone who cries, but she's already seen me cry and the others never have.

Speaker 1 [00:12:49] You can open up with your wife about your experiences, your thoughts, your identity, who you are, without fear of judgment or reprisal.

Speaker 2 [00:13:00] Right.

Speaker 1 [00:13:03] In the same way, what you're describing, if I understand correctly, is that you can have comfort or attention from the other, from your partner in case of danger or distress.

Speaker 2 [00:13:15] That's right. Yes, that's it. It's all one.

Speaker 1 [00:13:21] Could you give me some examples of these two things?

Speaker 2 [00:13:27] Ba like today, for example, it's going to fall well. Right now, at work, I'm having a little trouble with one of my bosses. The first thing I needed was to talk to my wife so that she could advise me, calm me down, guide me a bit, because I'm a very impulsive person, so I was about to leave, and so I called her to temper me, to be there for me, to tell me not to worry, "even if things aren't going well, I'm here". It sounds a bit like the role of a mother, but in fact it's not. Because I left my mother but I know that tomorrow I'll need my mother, I'll have her. But I need my wife. In fact, I know that today, I was very, very weak compared to my boss. So that did me a world of good, it lifted me up and gave me a bit of a boost to say to myself, "Go ahead, it's okay, I'll go. Thank you, sweetheart, I'm going".

Speaker 1 [00:14:35] It's a support, it's a supportive relationship? That you can rely on too?

Speaker 2 [00:14:40] Yes, that's fundamental too.

Speaker 1 [00:14:43] Yes, it's a bit, what you're describing if I understand correctly, it's also that the day-to-day functioning you have is regulated, or at least it helps you regulate, thanks to your partner or the relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:14:56] Yes. I don't want to speak for her, but I think that on the one hand, she can, it's a bit like that on her side too. After that, I don't know, but I think because we're very, very similar as a couple.

Speaker 1 [00:15:14] Would you say you feel secure in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:17] Ah yes! Ah totally. Yes, yes, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:15:23] Why would you say you feel safe?

Speaker 2 [00:15:26] Because quite simply, I know that even if she says “I'm going away for a week”, I know she'll come home. Even in the morning, at night, no matter who she talks to at night, she sleeps with me. I trust her, I trust her, not the others, but I trust her more. I know she loves me, she makes me feel it in her own way, but I know she loves me.

Speaker 1 [00:15:59] You know she loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:16:00] Yes, yes, my wife isn't very demonstrative, but I know she loves me.

Speaker 1 [00:16:05] How do you know she loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:16:07] It's in the way she looks at me, her little attentions, all that. Sometimes she doesn't have to say it, she just looks at me, I get it. Sometimes there's just a little gesture, a little, little smile. Just pouring my coffee means she loves me. It's those little things.

Speaker 1 [00:16:36] I'd like you to tell me about what you consider to be a high-quality relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:16:42] Honestly, I wouldn't even know. I think every relationship is completely different. Whether it's a couple, they've been together for [50-55] years or a young couple... I think every relationship is different and every person has that little something extra that other couples don't actually have. For me, the quality of my relationship is the support we have and the trust and love we have together. That's really our quality. After that, there are so many relationships that are so different that I wouldn't even be able to tell you what the great quality is, because everything is different in fact.

Speaker 1 [00:17:22] Of course, but once again, what I'm interested in here is your opinion and how you feel about it.

Speaker 2 [00:17:28] I'd say it's the conversation, the dialogue in a couple, I think it's a great quality. And it's often lost, it's often lost. It gets lost. I see it in other couples, in my couple in fact, we talk a lot, we need to say things to each other, so that at least things are put on the table and so we move forward and I think that dialogue, support and dialogue, it's a great quality. For me.



Speaker 1 [00:18:08] How do you know when you're in a relationship of dialogue, as you call it?

Speaker 2 [00:18:13] Well, actually, we can all say things without hiding them. It doesn't matter if it's bad or good, we can say it, we're not afraid of the other person's reaction.

Speaker 1 [00:18:30] Not to be afraid of the other person's reaction.

Speaker 2 [00:18:32] Yes, that's right.

Speaker 1 [00:18:36] When would you say your relationship was most about dialogue?

Speaker 2 [00:18:45] I'd say when we got married, when we got married. That's when I think we really communicated well, we found a way to communicate with each other.

Speaker 1 [00:19:03] Are you going to find a way to communicate?

Speaker 2 [00:19: 04] Yes, that's right, we found a way, because it's not easy sometimes to find the right words, especially when you don't really know each other, and you can't say you know your wife after a few months, but I think that when we became civil partners, that's when we started to communicate, when I managed to communicate, because I'm not an easy person to understand, and I'm not someone who talks a lot, I don't like to. And with my wife, I started when we entered into a civil partnership, when it became a union, I said to myself "maybe I need to communicate a bit more", even though I was already into it before, but more so since we entered into a civil partnership, and even more so since we got married. But it's true that the dialogue, yeah I'd say it started with the civil partnership.

Speaker 1 [00:20:01] And conversely, when was it least a relationship of communication, of dialogue?

Speaker 2 [00:20:06] I'd say in the early days.

Speaker 1 [00:20:11] To find that fit.

Speaker 2 [00:20:13] Right.

Speaker 1 [00:20:14] You were talking about. You talked a little bit about what a high-quality relationship is for you, and I'd like to know what a low-quality relationship is for you.

Speaker 2 [00:20:26] So that's lack of trust in the other person. For me, a couple who don't trust each other can't last. Trust is the basis. In fact, a couple is like a house. You build stone by stone, and trust is one of the fundamental foundations of a couple. So it's not easy. I'm someone who used to not be jealous at all, I've discovered that I'm a person now I'm jealous, but I trust her. I know that and I know that she knows that, I'd rather she said "here you are and I'd rather call it a day". And that's it, because I won't take it badly, because I trust her and I know she'll have told me things, because she trusted me. But trust, that's for sure. It's the lack of trust, it's a weak couple for me.

Speaker 1 [00:21:34] You said you were jealous.

Speaker 2 [00:21:36] Yeah. Ah it's not easy to assume that. But yeah. Yes, I tend to be jealous from time to time, a bit for nothing sometimes, but it's my way of telling him that I love him.

Speaker 1 [00:21:53] Why do you think you're jealous?

Speaker 2 [00:21:56] Because sometimes, when there's a boy talking to her and stuff, it gets on my nerves a bit.

Speaker 1 [00:22:02] Does it irritate you?

Speaker 2 [00:22:04] Yeah, it pisses me off a bit. I don't really like it.

Speaker 1 [00:22:10] You talked to me about trust and in the same way, I'd like to know when your relationship was the most trusting.

Speaker 2 [00:22:18] Right from the start. Yes, right from the start. It's been, I think automatically with her as with me. I also think, with the age we're at, well we're both at a certain age, we're not teenagers anymore. So I think that if we, I think it came right away, that's for sure. Yes, it did. Right

from the start of our relationship, there was a foundation of trust that was put in place and that has grown over time and will continue to grow in any case over time too.

Speaker 1 [00:23:03] You told me earlier about the previous relationships you've had, the age you're at, what allows you to know a bit more than you want to or etc. How many relationships have you had before? How many relationships have you had before? Before this one?

Speaker 2 [00:23:19] I'll tell you, plus the serious relationships I've had, I've had [1-5], lasting [1-5], [6-10] and [1-4] years.

Speaker 1 [00:23:32] You talked about what you consider to be a high-quality relationship, a low-quality relationship with trust and so on. And I'd like to know, I'd like you to tell me about the things, if there are others, that are the most important for you in a love relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:50] I need, well I need the person I'm with to trust me, to talk to me, to know that they can count on me, that's the most important thing, and to be happy.

Speaker 1 [00:24:03] May she be happy.

Speaker 2 [00:24:04] Yes, I need to feel that my wife is happy and I do everything I can to make her happy, I try. Because she wants, for a couple to work if one of them isn't happy, it can't work. It's not, and I think happiness is like a flower, you have to nurture it with little attentions, surprises, changes of habits too. It's not easy for me to change my habits, but little changes and little attentions, even if sometimes it's nothing at all, just a little word in the morning "Bonne journée mon amour, je t'aime", that's more than enough and that contributes to happiness. And I think that happiness is an integral part, for me, it's important trust, happiness and dialogue are the three fundamental pillars for me in a couple, that's for sure.

Speaker 1 [00:25:12] You mentioned this earlier in the interview, but I'd like you to tell me, based on what you've experienced, what love is for you.

Speaker 2 [00:25:22] So for me, love is, it's silly to say, but it's the need to be with the other person, to look at her all the time, even at night. I mean, I know that my heart speeds up when she's near me. We've been together for [1-5] year and a half and I still get butterflies in my stomach when I see her, even if I haven't seen her in the morning and I see her in the afternoon, I still get this little

butterfly in my stomach. I feel very euphoric, very... I have a permanent smile on my face. That's when my heart beats. It's really speeding up, speeding up and, as I say, every morning I fall in love with my wife all over again, and every day it's a little bit stronger than the day before. Yes, I'm completely addicted to my wife.

Speaker 1 [00:26:29] So for you, love is a very important part of your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:26:33] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:26:33] In a couple relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:26:35] Yes, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:26:39] Can you tell me about one of the last positive interactions you had with your wife?

Speaker 2 [00:26:50] Oh, just now, when she was finished, well, she was finished, she saw me coming and she came over and gave me a hug because she could see I wasn't necessarily feeling well and that gave me a boost, in fact. Or just yesterday in the car on the ring road, I was moaning, because the ring road is a horror and she was laughing because at one point I shouted something stupid and she started laughing like never before and that's only positive. To make her laugh for nothing, for nonsense on top of that, but that makes her laugh.

Speaker 1 [00:27:36] On the other hand, could you tell me about one of the last negative interactions you've had?

Speaker 2 [00:27:44] Due to her former relationship, in fact, as she has a child with her ex-spouse, I'm jealous of him because I'm afraid she'll go back to that relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:28:04] So what happened?

Speaker 2 [00:28:07] Well I told her, I mean I told her that I was afraid she'd go back to him, that I was afraid he'd play nice to show her that that's it. And no matter how much she tells me "no, no,

no”, I insist, I go to the weak spot until, well, until it screams a bit. But once it's screamed, I feel stupid. That's not great, because afterwards we sulk, and that's not good.

Speaker 1 [00:28:39] You sulk afterwards?

Speaker 2 [00:28:40] Afterwards, yeah, she sulks a bit, but I don't like it.

Speaker 1 [00:28:44] So how do you resolve these conflicts?

Speaker 2 [00:28:49] We leave each other alone. We go our separate ways and I make little interactions, “Do you want something to drink?” and I scratch around a bit like that until we talk again normally.

Speaker 1 [00:29:12] Are there any other conflicts or arguments you have about other subjects?

Speaker 2 [00:29:18] It's so rare that we argue. There are no more good times than bad, in fact. It's really rare. If we argue once a year, it's not bad. But they're good fights, worth their weight in gold. But at least there's only one.

Speaker 1 [00:29:40] And what about the little bumps in the road, the daily arguments?

Speaker 2 [00:29:46] We fight a lot, we argue a lot, but it's always like, “the dishes haven't been done” or “you haven't put these things away”, because I'm someone who leaves a lot of my shoes and things lying around, so she argues a bit with me, but it's really just a little tiff.

Speaker 1 [00:30:09] How often would you say that happens over I don't know at least a fortnight, for example?

Speaker 2 [00:30:14] Oh, I'd say three or four times. But still, it's an hour-long story. After that, it's good, it's over, it's forgotten.

Speaker 1 [00:30:25] I'd like you to talk to me too, since we're talking right now, about the arguments or conflicts you can have in a relationship, the challenges you have, have already overcome or still have to overcome in your relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:30:44] I don't really know. Right now, we're planning to buy a house. It's very, very complicated. With the current interest rate, it's a challenge for us, but for a lot of people, it would be something tense that could eventually cause a lot of altercations in their relationship, but it gives us strength because we motivate ourselves, she and I, by saying "well, it's not this house, it'll be another". And that's how we motivate ourselves. After that, our next challenge is to get the house. And then, above all, to have our own child. I think that will be our biggest challenge. After that, as a couple, we're kind of living from day to day. We see what's going on and it goes well. And then when things go wrong, well, we're together.

Speaker 1 [00:31:42] You're together when things go wrong.

Speaker 2 [00:31:44] Yes, yes, all the time in fact.

Speaker 1 [00:31:47] Are there any challenges that you feel you've already overcome in relation to what you've been through?

Speaker 2 [00:31:54] The fact that our characters, the fact that we manage to live together and get along like that is a challenge I think for her as much as for me, because we have two completely opposite characters. She's really very reserved. I'm someone who likes to have a laugh, I'm easy to talk to and I'm a complainer. She's a bit the same, but we're really two completely opposite characters, and I think the fact that we live together is already a challenge in itself, and one that we've achieved. Because we really got together, well, when we lived together, we couldn't say we knew each other like we do now. It's been a real challenge for us. First of all, moving in together from one day to the next. Because we didn't know if we were going to get along in character, and in the end we got along really well, because when she's upset, I manage to calm her down, and when I'm upset, she manages to calm me down, or when I'm sad, she makes me feel good. I mean, really. We're complementary in fact, even if we're opposites, but we are, we complete each other.

Speaker 1 [00:33:09] You complement each other.

Speaker 2 [00:33:10] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:33:15] I'd like you to tell me about your relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:33:24] With little touches. Yeah, it's often I mean, I'm someone who used to, I didn't pay attention to my other partners, but with my wife, I'm always doing little things like "making her coffee in the morning", I don't do it every day, but when I do it, I don't do it every day, but when I do it, it's because I need to do it, and also because it makes her happy, because she doesn't have anything to prepare, it's my morning kiss, the kiss when I arrive, the good night kiss, it's "hey, let's go to the restaurant tonight", we decide "come on, we're going to the restaurant tonight and I'm inviting you". And then it's a lot of little attentions, which helps maintain a certain balance, I think. Always being there to show him, even if sometimes you don't need to say I love you, just a little attention, that's so meaningful in fact.

Speaker 1 [00:34:32] Yeah. Attentions are significant.

Speaker 2 [00:34:38] Ah yes. yes yes.

Speaker 1 [00:34:41] I'd like to know what would make you leave your partner, your wife.

Speaker 2 [00:34:45] Cheating.

Speaker 1 [00:34:46] Deception?

Speaker 2 [00:34:48] Yes. Even if I still love her, but that I can't forgive. I come from a background where the day I get married, it's for life. And cheating makes me leave, even if it would hurt, but I'd rather leave. Because that would mean that if she's been elsewhere, it would mean that there's something that's not enough for her anymore, that she's found in someone else and gone elsewhere. So, on principle, I prefer to leave.

Speaker 1 [00:35:26] You said at the start of the interview, if I remember correctly, that for example you'd be, you'd accept her telling you she wanted to leave because she felt more comfortable? So that's something you'd be prepared to accept, but the deception would be like a betrayal?

Speaker 2 [00:35:43] Yes, because I'd rather she left me than cheat on me. Even if it's by saying "I'm leaving you because I've met someone, but before I do anything else, I'd rather leave everything".

I'll accept that much more easily than finding out she's cheated on me, where it's like taking a weight off my head and yeah, I won't get up like that easily. I'd rather say straight out, "Well, I've met someone. I'd rather say goodbye before something happens". I'd take it a lot better and I'd be happy for her because it would mean she'd found a happiness that I couldn't bring her. Even if it hurts in itself, but it's much easier to swallow.

Speaker 1 [00:36:36] You were talking at the beginning about the fact that what's important for you too in a relationship is that the other person is happy.

Speaker 2 [00:36:42] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:36:44] What's that got to do with it?

Speaker 2 [00:36:45] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:36:47] Or it would make it easier to accept, if ever, or at least to accept more easily, if ever the relationship ended, is to say that she would be happier or at least, that she would be happy. I'd like to know if you think you're the same person you were before your current relationship. In other words, has the relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:37:10] Ah completely, I'm completely someone else. Oh yes! I'm much more mature already. I've matured. I think that's what they say, I'm sorry, I'm having a bit of trouble with the French words, but I've matured, yeah, I've matured a lot. In my way of thinking, of seeing things, of accepting things. It's true, I've matured a lot - I'm really a totally different person than I was [1-5] years ago. And even those closest to me see it too. It's night and day.

Speaker 1 [00:37:51] Night and day.

Speaker 2 [00:37:52] Yes, I'm really totally different, I'm not the same person at all. Before, I wasn't patient, now I'm much more. Before, I was someone who would get angry, I mean, I'd go off at the drop of a hat, now I'm more likely to wait and see if it's really worth getting angry about. I'm very, very different.

Speaker 1 [00:38:20] What made you change then?



Speaker 2 [00:38:25] I think it's the fact that ba already accepted me and my past. I didn't necessarily hide it. She learned a bit about it too afterwards, but I didn't necessarily hide who I was before, and the fact that she accepted that, it gave me, I said to myself, well, we'll see how it goes and I'll, and then, as time went on, I wanted to change myself in fact to get to be, to an image that..., how can I say..., an image, that she would be much more. It's not for her that I've changed per se, it's also for me, but also for her, in the sense that she's much more mature than me, already from the start. That's it, and I wanted to get not to her stage, because I still need that childlike side, because it allows me to put a lot of things into perspective, but to get to a certain, a certain level. Where I say to myself, "I'm this age, my wife is that age", I want to be that person and I do everything I can to be that person, so in fact, I'm evolving for myself, but also for the well-being of my wife and my couple too, and of my entourage in general, because. And I'm all the happier for it now.

Speaker 1 [00:39:53] Would you say that, as far as your partner is concerned, what has changed during and compared to before the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:40:01] She's much happier than before. I knew her before our relationship when she was a bit off, a little bit, yeah she was really off and as time went on, until now, I find her much happier, much more fulfilled. She's more likely to approach people more easily because I think I've given her that too, confidence. Because I value her, I need to value her because she's my wife and I think that by valuing her, it's given her back a certain presence and that's beautiful. I think she's much happier, much more fulfilled than she was [1-5] years ago. And the people close to her can see it too, so they've said it themselves since I've been, well, texted it as "Since [Partner's Name], since you've been with [Partner's Name], you're much happier".

Speaker 1 [00:41:15] Is that something you've felt too?

Speaker 2 [00:41:17] Yes, I do.

Speaker 1 [00:41:21] I'd also like to talk about one of the constitutive dimensions of couple relationships, and that's sexuality. We know that it may or may not be a dimension that's more or less important in a relationship. Is it for you?

Speaker 2 [00:41:36] Ba. It's important, without actually being important. It's, it's a moment of sharing for us. I call it reconnecting the couple. It allows us to reconnect, to get back on the same, on the same path in fact. After that, it's not, it's important without really being important. For me,

it's really, it's not something that works on us all the time. And then we don't like it, well, it's...yes, it's quite, I don't know how to say it, it's very, it's not ordered, well when it happens, it's not ordered, it's just like that, it's the impulse, it's the moment, it's because we need, we feel she and I need to reconnect, to get together we'll say and then that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:42:41] Reconnect, you say?

Speaker 2 [00:42:42] Yeah, yeah, that's a cool term for me.

Speaker 1 [00:42:48] You think it's a cool term.

Speaker 2 [00:42:51] I think it's so meaningful. It's an update.

Speaker 1 [00:42:56] An update.

Speaker 2 [00:42:57] Yeah, that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:43:01] Right now, roughly speaking, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:43:08] Quite complicated because we're extremely tired, but I'd say if we manage to do it, 1 or 2 times every two weeks, that's not bad. It's true, we have a very, very hard job, and we're so tired that even if we wanted to, it's complicated.

Speaker 1 [00:43:29] Would you say you're satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:43:33] Yes, yes. Even if there's not much, it's good, it's good, it's even very good. We get along very, very well on that.

Speaker 1 [00:43:52] You told me it's complicated at the moment because you're very tired. Because you have very demanding jobs? Is that it?

Speaker 2 [00:44:00] That's right, yes. We get up very, very early. Most of the time, we arrive in the evening, have dinner, watch a movie, and if it's not the movie that's watching us, it's very, very tiring.

Speaker 1 [00:44:17] I've only heard what you're saying. I'll share my screen with you. I'm going to show you a scale. I'd like you to answer two of its items. So usually, my partner really listens to me. It goes from 1 to 9, 1 being not at all true 9 completely true, where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2 [00:44:49] 9

Speaker 1 [00:44:51] So why 9.

Speaker 2 [00:44:54] Because when I'm talking to her, you know when someone's really listening to you, it's because the person looks you straight in the eye, that means the person's really listening to you and every time I say something, they're always looking me in the eye.

Speaker 1 [00:45:04] So why not 8?

Speaker 2 [00:45:11] I wouldn't say eight because it's always if I'm talking, it's because it's important. She's aware of the importance when I need to talk, she takes on the importance and as a result I feel really listened to with her, in any case, I'm very very well listened to.

Speaker 1 [00:45:35] My partner really listens to my needs? On the same scale, where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2 [00:45:40] Oh, I'd say eight.

Speaker 1 [00:45:43] So why 8?

Speaker 2 [00:45:46] You have to think about her a bit, it can't be nine everywhere.

Speaker 1 [00:45:55] So why not 7?

Speaker 2 [00:45:59] Because she puts me before her own needs.

Speaker 1 [00:46:08] Why not 9 then?

Speaker 2 [00:46:11] Because she's thinking about herself, but she's still thinking about me first, but I'd say eight because it's a happy medium compared to that.

Speaker 1 [00:46:24] So how satisfied are you with your relationship? So it goes from completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, somewhat neutral, somewhat satisfied, very satisfied and completely satisfied. Where would you put yourself?

Speaker 2 [00:46:36] I'd say completely satisfied. I have everything I need in my relationship. Everything I'm looking for, I have in her.

Speaker 1 [00:46:46] Well, you've given me a linguistic answer. If we were to transform this scale into a numerical form, it would look like this: zero would be completely unsatisfied and ten would be completely satisfied. Where would you put it?

Speaker 2 [00:46:58] Ah ba ten.

Speaker 2 [00:47:01] So why? Why ten?

Speaker 2 [00:47:03] Because I'm a top woman. I have a really perfect relationship. In fact, I couldn't find a better relationship, even in the future, than this one.

Speaker 1 [00:47:19] Why? Why not nine?

Speaker 2 [00:47:22] Because that would be lying.

Speaker 1 [00:47:24] Right. Listen, we're coming to the end of the interview. Is there anything you'd like to clarify? We've talked about how you met your partner, your wife, what a quality relationship

was for you, whether it was high quality or low quality. You talked to me about trust. We also talked about the things that were important to you in a relationship. Making the other person happy, for example, or knowing they're happy. I was told about the importance of love for you in a relationship. About what it was, about how you knew your partner loved you, through attentions, through looks. You also told me about the conflicts you can sometimes have, often linked to jealousy, which you can have, as well as little everyday snags, and how you resolve these conflicts by giving yourself space and communicating, by talking about dialogue, we talked about that too.

Speaker 2 [00:48:36] I've spoken to you from the heart, so to speak. So there's nothing you'd like to correct or add.